

Last time we introduced the question of what we should believe. We began by considering this rule of belief:

No Proof $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you can't give a good
argument for P, don't
believe P.

But we saw that this led to the result that you should not believe anything at all, which seems very implausible.

At the very least, it seems, we should believe things that we can be certain of:

Certainty $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can rule out any situation which would make P false, you should believe P.

Experience → Belief

If your sense experience tells you that P, and you have no reason to think that your sense experience is misleading, you should believe P.

Proof $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can prove
P, you should
believe P.

This is a version of a view known as foundationalism.

It can be summed up with the following negative rule of belief:

No Foundations → No Belief

If you can't be certain that P and your senses don't tell you that P and you can't give a good argument for P, you should not believe P.

The last premise of this argument just is our proposed No

Foundations $\rightarrow$ No Belief rule.

It also came up earlier in the course. On the second day, I said that there were two main kinds of arguments against belief in God.

The first are the various versions of the argument from evil
which we discussed at length.

The second is the argument that you should not believe that God exists because there is no evidence that God exists.

We can now put that second argument in a more precise form.

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